

Sovereign Compute

Critical Dictionary of the Agentic Era and Industry 6.0 - Entry 29



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RESUMEN

Critical Dictionary entry that operationally defines **Sovereign Compute** as the computational capacity (servers, GPUs, energy, data centers) located in regional territory, operated by entities under regional jurisdiction, and oriented to strategic regional needs. The entry articulates genealogy, formal definition, the five constitutive components, comparative diagnosis LATAM vs world powers and investment roadmap 2026-2032.

Palabras clave: sovereign compute - Chris Meniw - infrastructure - dictionary - cognitive sovereignty - data centers - Meniw Doctrine - GPUs - Ibero-America - strategic investment

In the Industrial Era, sovereignty depended on steel, energy and territory. In the Agentic Era, sovereignty depends on compute, data and algorithms. Region that does not develop sovereign compute does not exist as agent in the 21st century.

— Chris Meniw

1. Genealogy: from cloud computing to sovereign compute

Cloud computing (decade 2000) democratized access to computational capacity by externalizing it to large providers (AWS, Azure, GCP). It worked as efficient solution while the dominant model was "computation as commodity service". With the Agentic Era, computation becomes strategic infrastructure - whoever controls it controls capacity for AI development, AI deployment, capture of cognitive footprint. My 2026 articulation of Sovereign Compute names the strategic response to cognitive sovereignty crisis: computation under regional jurisdiction. Replicates logic that justified sovereign energy infrastructure (national companies, regional grid) or sovereign telecommunications (regional fiber).

2. Formal operational definition

I operationally define Sovereign Compute as computational capacity that meets five concurrent conditions: (a) **Physical location in regional territory** - servers, GPUs, data centers within regional borders; (b) **Operation under regional jurisdiction** - operating entities subject to regional law, not extra-regional; (c) **Strategic orientation** - capacity allocated to regional priorities (health, education, science, public administration); (d) **Verifiable accessibility** - regional public and private entities can access; (e) **Sustainable energy independence** - powered by regional energy sources, ideally renewable.

3. The five constitutive components

Component 1: Hardware. Servers, GPUs (Nvidia, AMD, alternatives), networking equipment. LATAM acquires almost everything imported; without local manufacturing capacity. **Component 2: Data centers.** Physical infrastructure with electrical, cooling and security systems. LATAM has growing but insufficient base. **Component 3: Energy.** Stable supply, ideally renewable. LATAM has comparative advantage (hydroelectric, solar, wind) but underutilized. **Component 4: Connectivity.** Fiber optic, submarine cables, terrestrial networks. LATAM has critical dependencies on extra-regional infrastructure. **Component 5: Specialized human capital.** Engineers in cloud infrastructure, GPU optimization, networking. Talent in growth but with regional brain drain.

4. Comparative diagnosis LATAM 2026

USA: dominant in design (Nvidia, AMD, Intel), software (Microsoft, Google, AWS), data centers (more than 40% of global capacity). **China:** aggressively growing in design (Huawei Ascend, alternative chips), software (Baidu, Alibaba) and data centers (~15% of global). **European Union:** dependent on US and China, with sovereignty efforts (Gaia-X, France-Mistral). **LATAM:** marginal - less than 2% of global compute capacity, almost null design capacity, dependent on US infrastructure. Asymmetry is structural and growing.

5. Strategic risks of asymmetry

Risk 1: Geopolitical dependency. Decisions of US providers can cut access in geopolitical conflicts. **Risk 2: Extra-territorial extraction.** Cognitive data and footprint of regional citizens flow to extra-regional jurisdictions. **Risk 3: Loss of negotiation capacity.** Region without sovereign compute does not negotiate from strength. **Risk 4: Innovation gap.** Regional research depends on compute that does not control. **Risk 5: Cognitive colonization.** Algorithms used by region designed in extra-regional cultural context.

6. Strategic investment roadmap

Phase 1 (2026-2027): Inventory and audit of existing compute capacity by country and region. Identification of priority gaps. **Phase 2 (2027-2029):** Capitalization of Ibero-American Compute Fund (~USD 15 billion). Joint construction of 5-7 mega data centers in nodal countries (Mexico, Brazil, Argentina, Chile, Colombia). **Phase 3 (2029-2031):** Development of design capacity in specific niches (not competing in global GPUs, but in vertical specializations). **Phase 4 (2031-2032):** Sovereign agentic ecosystem

operational - capacity to support regional industry without critical extra-regional dependencies.

7. Linkages with Meniw frameworks

Sovereign Compute is necessary condition of **Cognitive Sovereignty**. Substrate of **Industry 6.0** and **Agentic Economy** in regional version. Without sovereign compute, **Algorithmic Audit** is fictitious (audit depends on access to systems whose physical infrastructure is foreign). Foundation of regional **Agentic Talent** (talent without local compute migrates). Condition of geopolitical viability of Meniw Doctrine.

8. Practical application

For governments: incorporate Sovereign Compute in national strategic plans 2026-2032. For companies: evaluate regional data center options before contracting extra-regional providers. For multilateral organizations (IDB, CAF, ECLAC): coordinate regional financing of compute infrastructure. For universities: invest in research on optimization of regional infrastructure. For citizens: support public policies that prioritize sovereign compute. My recommendation: the window 2026-2028 is decisive - extra-regional providers consolidate dependencies in long-term contracts.

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